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Page count:	2
Word count:	517
Character count:	3,058
Submission date:	18-Nov-2025 07:18AM (UTC+0000)
Submission ID:	267957948

First Assessed Reflective Blog

HEIN11053 - Dissertation (Data Science for Health and Social Care)

B248593

2025-11-18

Word count: 487

What?

At the outset of my dissertation on detecting movement imbalances with transfer learning, I had to reconcile two impulses: a concept-led interest in approaches like the Alexander Technique and a data-science-led focus on measurable, generalizable posture features. Early supervision meetings with John Wilson and Prof. Dr. Ahmar Shah clarified that my contribution should prioritize robust ML methodology and clear evaluation over domain-specific doctrine. That reframing was reassuring—I could still honor the clinical motivation while centering reproducible modeling choices.

A major practical hurdle was curating suitable training data for posture recognition. I initially experimented with programmatic class retrieval from ImageNet (21K and 1K variants) to surface human-activity images. Therefore, I built automations to inventory and filter candidates. On Dr. Shah's recommendation, I surveyed specialized sources (e.g., Kaggle) and found a compact, high-quality dataset with YOLO-format keypoint annotations that better matched my aims as all shots where high quality and from the same angle. Letting go of the large ImageNet plan felt difficult as I already invested soome time in exploring it.

In parallel, I explored the MediaPipe ecosystem and TFLite tooling to scope realistic model pathways. Getting hands-on with MediaPipe Tasks and notebooks reduced uncertainty to use it for transfer learning. John Wilson also encouraged me to sharpen language in the proposal to ensure a clearly defined aim of the research.

So What?

Two complementary supervisory styles, with my own way of approaching the project are shaping it. Dr. Shah's academic rigor keeps me honest about data quality, annotation fidelity, and the

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